Waseem Raza, PhD (Electrical and Computer Engineering)

Computer Science Educator-Scholar | Applied ML, Data Science & Networked Systems

Undergraduate Programming & Mentoring | Reliable AI Research | Industry-Connected Computing

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LinkedIn | GitHub | Google Scholar | Coursera Courses | Portfolio

Academic Profile

PhD in Electrical and Computer Engineering (University of Oklahoma, 2025) with university-level teaching in Computer Programming, Communication Systems and Wireless Communication, additional lab and research mentoring, and applied ML engineering experience. Research spans robust and data-efficient machine learning, network analytics, wearable sensing and reproducible computational experiments. Interested in undergraduate CS teaching and accessible student research linking programming, algorithmic reasoning and empirical evaluation.

Research Interests

Reliable and Data-Efficient Machine Learning; Data Science, Time-Series Analytics and Responsible AI; Computer and Wireless Networks; Network and Sensor Data Modeling; Reproducible Computing and Undergraduate Capstone Research

Doctoral Research Focus

PhD dissertation in AI/ML for wireless networks: outage detection, self-healing decisions, data-efficient and generative propagation models, transfer learning under distribution shift, and reproducible computational evaluation.

Education

PhD, Electrical and Computer Engineering *09/2019 - 07/2025*

University of Oklahoma, Norman, Oklahoma, USA

MSc, Telecommunication Engineering *08/2014 - 08/2016*

University of Engineering and Technology, Taxila, Pakistan

BSc, Telecommunication Engineering *11/2010 - 06/2014*

University of Engineering and Technology, Taxila, Pakistan

Relevant Graduate Coursework

LTE Networks and Telecommunications; Emerging 5G Systems; Advanced ML and Computer Vision; Wireless Testbed Design; Numerical Analysis; Information Theory; Digital Signal Processing

Teaching, Research & Professional Experience

Teaching & Instruction

Lecturer, Department of Technology **12/2017 - 09/2019**

University of Lahore, Pakistan *Lahore, Pakistan*

- Taught programming, communication systems, and wireless communication with practical examples.
- Advised senior-design students on projects, academic plans, and early careers.
- Aligned course materials with learning outcomes and accreditation standards.
- Supported accreditation, exams, technical workshops, and student activities.

Teaching areas: Computer Programming (previous university instruction); Applied Machine Learning and Data Science (research and industry expertise); Computer and Communication Networks (technical expertise); Computational Problem Solving and Python; Data Analysis and Reproducible Experiments; Capstone Research Mentoring and Software Projects

Student mentoring and research development

- Advised undergraduate student projects and supported Bachelor's and Master's thesis research, including simulation, implementation and technical communication.
- Helped students scope tractable experiments and document assumptions, methods and results.
- Designed and supported laboratory exercises and worked examples connecting technical concepts with testing and interpretation.

University Research Appointments

Graduate Research Assistant **09/2019 - 07/2025**

AI4Networks, University of Oklahoma *Tulsa, OK*

- Built 3GPP-compliant Python simulation tools and an AI-enabled 5G research testbed.
- Built GAN, transfer-learning, autoencoder, and reinforcement-learning models for wireless data.
- Led 100+ experiments testing wireless ML under domain shift and limited labeled data.
- Developed self-healing and outage-management methods, improving resilience by 30%.
- Published wireless AI research and mentored junior researchers in experimental design.

Research Associate, ComSens Lab **06/2016 - 12/2017**

COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan *Islamabad, Pakistan*

- Modeled wireless communication systems through simulation, analysis, and technical reports.
- Mentored Bachelor's and Master's theses in experiment design and research presentation.
- Reviewed student reports and manuscripts for rigor and publication readiness.
- Supported proposals, literature reviews, lab seminars, and research coordination.

Full-Time Research Scholar, Communication Systems Lab **08/2014 - 02/2016**
University of Engineering and Technology, Taxila, Pakistan *Taxila, Pakistan*

- Researched wireless communication systems while completing an MSc in Telecommunications.
- Supported communications courses, labs, assignments, grading, and examinations.
- Led wireless communication labs and prepared technical manuals and experiments.
- Developed course and student-project materials for practical wireless engineering.

Industry Research & Engineering

Machine Learning Engineer **02/2025 - Present**
AT&T, contractor via Innovatix Inc. *Bedminster, NJ*

- Applied domain-adaptive ML to telecom service assurance and model validation.
- Designed cross-domain evaluation and error-analysis methods for operational ML.
- Worked with engineering and public-safety teams on reliable network assurance.

Data Scientist and AI/ML Engineer **09/2024 - 12/2024**
Impac Exploration Services *Weatherford, OK*

- Built LLM-enabled analytics to interpret geochemical well data for decision support.
- Built Python pipelines in Azure Databricks, Functions, and Synapse Analytics.
- Automated exploration-data ETL, cutting preparation time by 40%.
- Used data-validation and quality controls to improve output reliability by 20%.
- Turned geologists' technical needs into structured datasets and useful analytics.

Advanced-Degrees Intern **06/2024 - 08/2024**
AT&T Labs *Austin, TX*

- Analyzed 500K+ LTE/5G-NR logs with ML, reducing diagnostic time by 20%.
- Improved 5G NR-NTN cell selection by 15% through data-driven validation.
- Presented operational data insights to next-generation wireless engineering teams.

Advanced Wireless Technology Development Intern **09/2022 - 01/2023**
Futurewei Technologies *Schaumburg, IL*

- Improved wireless CSI compression by 25% with transfer learning and autoencoders.
- Ran 50+ experiments on wireless ML robustness under changing data conditions.
- Translated research results into recommendations for future wireless networks.

Advanced-Degrees Intern **06/2022 - 08/2022**
AT&T Labs *Bedminster, NJ*

- Improved 5G standalone user-timing precision by 20% with ML and statistics.
- Analyzed user traces with SQL and presented results to engineering leadership.
- Turned operational traces into indicators for network diagnosis and optimization.

Research Contributions

Publications

Real-World Medication Adherence Monitoring Using Hybrid Neural Networks and Smartwatches *HealthINF | Accepted* 2026

AI-Powered Resilience: A Dual-Approach for Outage Management in Dense Cellular Networks *Computer Communications* 2025 | DOI

On Multi-Parameter Optimization and Proactive Reliability in 5G and Beyond Cellular Networks *Sensors 2025* 2025 | DOI

An AI-Driven Framework for Enhancing Resilience in Propagation Models to Enable Digital Twin *IEEE PIMRC* 2024 | DOI

Refining Wireless Propagation Models using Domain-Informed GANs amid Data Scarcity *IEEE VTC-Fall 2024* 2024 | Link

Data-Driven Intelligent Outage Management for High Shadowing Environments in 5G&B Networks *IEEE SmartNets* 2024

An AI-Enabled Framework to Defend Ingenious MDT-Based Attacks on the Emerging Zero Touch Cellular Networks *IEEE Network, 38(1), 228-237* 2024 | DOI

Positioning Error Impact Compensation through Data-Driven Optimization in User-Centric Networks *IEEE GLOBECOM 2023* 2023 | Link

Research Projects & Platforms

Wearable Intelligence for Health Monitoring *Research Project | 2024-2026*

Developed deep-learning workflows for recognizing medication-taking and dietary activities from smartwatch accelerometer and gyroscope signals in free-living settings. Evaluated windowing, feature extraction, CNN/LSTM-style sequence models, cross-user generalization, and recall-oriented performance for health-monitoring applications.

Tools & Methods: Wearable AI, Smartwatch IMU, Time Series, Deep Learning, CNN/LSTM, Feature Engineering, Cross-User Evaluation, Activity Recognition, Healthcare AI

SyntheticNET: 3GPP-Compliant Network Simulation *Research Project | 2020-2024*

Developed a Python-based, 3GPP-aligned simulation environment for realistic mobility, propagation, and cellular-network experimentation when measured data is sparse or costly. Supported controlled data generation and repeatable studies in propagation modeling, network optimization, digital twins, and resilient wireless AI.

Tools & Methods: Python, 3GPP, Wireless Simulation, Mobility Modeling, Propagation Modeling, Synthetic Data, Experiment Design, Digital Twins, Network Analytics

TurboRAN Experimental Platform *Research Infrastructure | 2020-2024*

Built and used a multi-band, multi-tier experimental platform for evaluating AI-enabled radio-access-network methods under controlled network conditions. Supported repeatable measurement collection, testbed experimentation, RAN optimization studies, and validation of emerging wireless-network algorithms.

Tools & Methods: 5G Testbeds, RAN, Network Measurement, Experiment Design, Wireless Prototyping, Multi-Band Systems, Performance Evaluation, RAN Optimization

Propagation Models & Digital Twins *Research Project | 2024*

Developed robust data-driven radio-propagation models for wireless digital twins using domain-informed generative learning and scarce measured data. Combined 3GPP-informed pretraining, GAN-based augmentation, domain adaptation, and statistical validation to improve resilience under distribution shift.

Tools & Methods: Propagation Modeling, Digital Twins, GANs, Domain Adaptation, 3GPP Models, Synthetic Data, Statistical Validation, Wireless AI, Distribution Shift

AI for Telecom Network & Security Optimization *Certification Project | 2026*

Applied AI concepts to telecommunications network optimization, security analysis, and customer-experience improvement through a structured specialization project. Framed telecom use cases around operational data, AI-assisted analysis, optimization opportunities, and practical service-improvement recommendations.

Tools & Methods: AI for Telecommunications, Network Optimization, Telecom Security, Customer Experience, Python, TensorFlow, Operational Analytics, Service Improvement

Research Methods & Technical Expertise

Teaching & Mentoring: Undergraduate computer programming instruction, problem-solving instruction, student-project advising, communications laboratories, research mentoring, structured feedback and technical writing

Computer Science & Software: Python, C/C++, programming fundamentals, debugging, software workflows, SQL, Git, Linux, numerical computing, data visualization and reproducible experiments

Machine Learning & Data Science: Scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, classification, regression, deep learning, time-series modeling, model evaluation, fairness analysis, transfer learning and data-efficient ML

Networks & Intelligent Systems: Computer and wireless networks, network measurements, performance analysis, LTE/5G systems, anomaly detection, reliability and optimization

Research Methods: Experimental design, model comparison, simulation, error analysis, cross-validation, distribution-shift studies, open datasets, transparent reporting and student-accessible computational research

Academic Service & Recognition

Academic Service

- Supported instructional assessment, examinations, course and laboratory materials, and curriculum-related activities.
- Contributed to research seminars, workshops, student technical projects and review of academic reports.

Honors & Awards

William H. Barkow Scholarship *2024*
University of Oklahoma, Electrical and Computer Engineering

Clyde L. Farrar Endowment Scholarship *2024*
University of Oklahoma

P.H. Robinson Fellowship *2023*
University of Oklahoma

FAS-Charles Forgan Scholarship *2023*
University of Oklahoma

Nettie Vincent Boggs Graduate Endowment *2022*
University of Oklahoma

SHS-Paul D. Massad Scholarship *2022*
University of Oklahoma

Cleo Cross Memorial Scholarship *2021*
University of Oklahoma

Marjorie Haskell Engineering Scholarship *2021*
University of Oklahoma

Fully Funded PhD / Graduate Research Assistantship *2019*
University of Oklahoma

Self-Learning

1. Machine Learning Stanford/Coursera | Completed | Mar 2020
Supervised and unsupervised learning, regularization, model evaluation, and practical predictive modeling.

2. Python for Data Science, AI & Development IBM/Coursera | Completed | Jul 2026
Python programming, data analysis, APIs, and reproducible data-science workflows.

3. Introduction to Deep Learning & Neural Networks with Keras IBM/Coursera | Completed | Aug 2026
Neural networks, training workflows, optimization, loss functions, and model evaluation with Keras.

4. Introduction to Computer Vision with TensorFlow Google/Coursera | Completed | Aug 2024
Image processing and convolutional neural networks for computer vision using TensorFlow.

5. Generative AI Engineering and Fine-Tuning Transformers IBM/Coursera | Completed | Aug 2026
Transformer architectures, model fine-tuning, embeddings, and generative-AI engineering.